Godown Ledger — Client training guide

Audience: Owner, bookkeeper, godown keeper, and sales staff at a textile trading office.
Purpose: Learn what each part of the software does and how your team uses it day to day.
Updated: 21 October 2026 (Pakistan time).

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1. What this software is

Godown Ledger is a **web application** for mill-to-market textile trading:

- Receive yarn/cloth in the **godown** (warehouse), lot by lot.
- **Price** received stock, then **sell** against specific lots (FEFO/FIFO).
- Track **buyer udhar** (credit) and **recovery** (collections).
- Pay **mills** and manage **accounts** (double-entry books).
- Run **reports**, **evening close**, and **encrypted backups**.

Office computers and phones only need a **browser** and **internet**. You do not install Node.js, PostgreSQL, or Git on staff PCs.

For Lahore production handover specifics (PIN desk, Excel WhatsApp flow), also read `CLIENT-HANDOVER.md` in this folder.

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2. Opening the system

Production (Lahore office)

1. Open the **HTTPS address** supplied at handover (bookmark it on every desk).
2. Sign in with the **shared mill email and password**.
3. Select **your name** and enter your **four-digit PIN**.
4. When you leave the computer, press **Leave the desk** so the next person uses their own PIN.

Rule	Detail
Wrong PIN	Does not open the desk
Lockout	Five wrong attempts → PIN locked **15 minutes**
Owner PIN	Private — never give to staff
People	Owner adds staff under **Users** (or **More → People and pins** on some builds)

Demo / developer login (training only)

If your trainer uses a demo server, log in with **email + password** and role-based accounts (see trainer's credentials sheet). Production clients should **not** rely on demo logins.

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3. Who does what (roles)

Role	Typical person	Can do	Cannot do

Godown keeper (Storekeeper)	Warehouse	Mills, physical stock, unpriced receipts, adjustments	See rates, books, or buyer balances
Salesman	Field / counter sales	Bills, buyers, recovery	Purchase costs, full accounts, exports
Bookkeeper (Accountant)	Office accounts	Price stock, purchases, returns, direct deals, ledger, evening note, exports	User admin, full backup restore (owner)
Owner	Proprietor	Everything — people, settings, backups	—
Cashier (if used)	Counter	Quick sales and receipts	Most masters and accounting

Exact permissions are enforced on the server; hiding a menu item is **not** security. If someone sees "Forbidden", their role is not allowed that action.

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4. One normal trading day (recommended order)

Use this as your **daily checklist** until it becomes habit.

Step	Who	Where in app	What happens
1	Owner / bookkeeper	**Inventory**, **Buyers**, **Mills**	Products (quality/count, unit, default rates) and buyers exist
2	Keeper	**Inventory** → receive stock	Cloth received: mill, product, **lot/thaan**, quantity (up to 3 decimals), shade/location notes — **waiting for rate**, not saleable
3	Bookkeeper	**Price received cloth** (or priced **Purchase**)	Adds cost/selling rates; lot becomes **saleable**; mill credited
4	Salesman	**Sales** → new bill	Bill against a **specific lot**; credit needs registered buyer; walk-in must be **fully paid**
5	Salesman / bookkeeper	**Buyers** → recovery	Money from buyers; allocated to oldest overdue first
6	Bookkeeper	Mill payments / **Purchases**	Pay mills; **PDC cheques** stay uncleared until deposited
7	Owner / bookkeeper	**Direct deals**	Mill → buyer without godown stock (see §7)
8	Any authorised role	**Returns** from original bill/purchase	Server checks qty, price, cost
9	Owner / bookkeeper	**Evening close**, **P&L**, **Trial balance**, **Balance sheet**	Reconcile day; share Excel note (§12)

10	Owner	**Settings** → backup	Encrypted backup; key stored separately

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5. Sidebar map (every main screen)

The left menu is grouped as follows. Paths are the URL after your site address.

Overview

Menu	Path	Purpose
Dashboard	`/`	Today's sales, receivables, low stock, recent bills
Alerts	`/alerts`	Expiry and low-stock warnings (textile lots often have no expiry)

Operations

Menu	Path	Purpose
Inventory	`/inventory`	Products, batches/lots, on-hand qty, movement history
Reorder Sheet	`/inventory/reorder`	Items at or below reorder level
Stock Adjustment	`/inventory/adjustments/new`	Correct physical count (shrinkage, recount) — keeper/bookkeeper
Sales	`/sales`	Create and view **posted** sale invoices
Offline Invoice	`/sales/offline`	Queue bills when connection is poor; sync when back online
Purchases	`/purchases`	Mill purchases and returns
Expenses	`/expenses`	Operating expenses by category

People

Menu	Path	Purpose
Buyers	`/customers`	Customer master, balance, recovery, statements
Mills	`/suppliers`	Supplier master and payables
Pay Schedule	`/suppliers/schedule`	Planned mill payments

Sales (field)

Menu	Path	Purpose
Quotations	`/quotations`	Quotes before billing
Routes	`/routes`	Route/visit planning for salesmen

Finance

Menu	Path	Purpose
Accounts	`/accounts`	Chart of accounts, cash payment/received, opening balance, ledger
Bank Accounts	`/accounts/bank`	Bank balances and movements
PDC Cheques	`/accounts/pdc`	Post-dated cheques: pending → deposited → cleared/bounced

Analytics

Menu	Path	Purpose
Reports	`/reports`	Hub for all report cards
Evening close	`/reports/evening`	Day summary text + Excel preparation
Sales Targets	`/reports/targets`	Monthly targets vs achievement
P&L Statement	`/reports/pl`	Profit and loss for a period
Balance Sheet	`/reports/balance-sheet`	Assets, liabilities, equity snapshot

System

Menu	Path	Purpose
Users	`/users`	Staff accounts and roles (owner/admin)
Settings	`/settings`	Company profile, sequences, backup export

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6. Inventory and lots (godown)

Concepts

- **Product** — cloth type (quality, count, unit: kg / metre / thaan).
- **Batch / lot** — one receipt from a mill with its own quantity and optional lot number.
- **FEFO** — system prefers earliest-expiry lots; textile often uses **FIFO by receive date** when there is no expiry.
- **Movement history** — every in/out with document reference and Pakistan date (keeper view may hide money).

Keeper workflow

1. **Receive** cloth → status **waiting for rate** (not on sale list).
2. Do **not** dispatch again when a sales bill is posted — stock deducts automatically.
3. Use **Stock adjustment** only for physical corrections, with a clear reason.

Bookkeeper workflow

1. Open **Price received cloth** (or enter a full **Purchase** with rates).
2. After posting, lot appears as **saleable** stock.

3. Review **Stock valuation** report for cost value.

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7. Sales, recovery, and direct deals

Sales invoice

- Every line must reference a **lot** with enough quantity.
- **Credit (udhar):** buyer must exist on file.
- **Cash / walk-in:** must be **fully paid** at posting.
- Quantities: up to **3 decimal places** where needed.

Recovery

- Record payments against buyers from the buyer ledger or receipt screens.
- Allocation: **oldest overdue invoice first**, then amount.
- Opening balances without invoice dates appear in **aging** as undated.

Direct deals (mill → buyer, no godown)

- Owner/bookkeeper enters: mill, buyer, quantity, **cost** and **selling** rate.
- **Godown stock unchanged.**
- Salesman may see the **sales side** and collect recovery **without** seeing purchase cost.
- Returns: reverse linked payments first, then reverse the deal — **no stock return**.

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8. Purchases, mills, and returns

- **Purchase order** increases stock (when priced) and mill payable.
- **Purchase return** reduces stock and **credits** the mill; only from original purchase, unreturned qty.
- **Sale return** reduces buyer balance; walk-in returns may refund cash.
- Always start returns from the **original document** so prices and tax stay correct.

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9. Accounts (books)

Godown Ledger uses **double-entry accounting**: every financial event creates balanced journal lines.

Task	Typical entry point
Cash in / out	**Accounts** → cash received / cash payment
Opening balances	Opening balance wizard (owner/accountant)
Manual correction	**Vouchers** (journal entries)
Day book	**Ledger**
Bank	**Bank accounts**
PDC	**PDC cheques** — not counted as cleared cash until presented

End of month: **Trial balance** must tie; then **P&L** and **Balance sheet**.

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10. Reports catalog

Open **Reports** for the full list. Common reports:

Report	Use when
Evening close	End-of-day WhatsApp / owner review
Sales / Sales detail	Register of bills and line profit
Sales by customer	Monthly buyer totals
Cash receiving (product-wise)	Which products cash related to
Purchases	Mill-wise buying
Stock valuation	Qty and value in godown
Customer recovery	Who owes what
Aging	0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ buckets
Collection	Salesman collections by day
Salesman performance	Sales vs recovery %
Area-wise	Route/area grouping
FBR tax summary	GST summary for filing prep
Audit log	Who accessed what (owner/admin)

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11. Multi-desk behaviour (important)

- All desks share **one database** on the server.
- List screens **refresh about every 5 seconds** while visible and online.
- Refresh **pauses** while you are typing — finish the form or reopen the screen.
- Two users cannot oversell the same lot — second post gets an error; **do not duplicate** a bill after a connection glitch until you check the bill list.
- **Internet required** for cloud hosting; private financial pages are not stored offline on the device.

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12. Evening close and Excel sharing

1. Open **Evening close** — review purchases, sales, recovery, mill payments, stock flags.
2. **Prepare Excel for WhatsApp** (owner/bookkeeper).
3. **Phone: Share Excel file** when the browser supports it.
4. **Desktop: Download prepared Excel** → WhatsApp → **Attach → Document**.
5. **Email the note** sends text only — attach the workbook yourself.

The workbook has **11 tabs**: Summary, Purchases, Sales, Recovery, Mill Payments, Stock, Returns, Waiting for Rate, Buyer Dues, Accounts, Evening Note. Dates use **Pakistan time**. Prepare a **fresh copy** if entries change before sending.

Automatic scheduled email/WhatsApp delivery is **separate setup** — confirm with your administrator.

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13. Backups and first-day balances

- **Owner** downloads **encrypted** backups; store the **passphrase/key separately** from the file.
- Nightly cloud backup may be configured by your implementer — confirm destination and test restore quarterly.
- **Historical manual books** are not auto-imported. Agree **launch date** and opening stock, cash, buyer dues, and mill payables with the owner/accountant before live trading.
- Never send passwords, PINs, database URLs, or decrypted backups in WhatsApp chat.

See `BACKUP-RECOVERY.md` for technical recovery (IT/admin).

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14. Suggested training plan for your client

Train in this order over **3–5 short sessions** (30–45 minutes each):

Session	Audience	Topics	Practice exercise
A	Everyone	Login, leave desk, dashboard, sync rules	Each person logs in and out once
B	Keeper	Receive unpriced cloth, movement history	One real lot with notes
C	Bookkeeper	Price stock, one purchase, stock report	One lot from waiting → saleable
D	Salesman	One credit bill, one cash bill, recovery	Bill against priced lot; record partial recovery
E	Bookkeeper + owner	Returns, PDC, direct deal demo	Return line from original bill
F	Owner + bookkeeper	Evening close, Excel share, P&L/trial balance	Full close on a training day
G	Owner only	Users/PINs, backup download	Add test user; download backup

Keep a **one-page cheat sheet** (§4) laminated at each desk.

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15. Support checklist

When something fails, send your administrator:

1. **Bill or document number**
2. **Screen name** (menu item)
3. **Time in Pakistan**
4. **Exact error text** (screenshot)

Do **not** send secrets or decrypted backups.

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16. Not included in this release (unless separately agreed)

- FBR electronic invoicing integration

- Fully automated evening delivery without provider setup
- Multi-godown transfers, per-thaan length conversion, dyeing/job-work modules

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Related files in `docs/`

File	For
`CLIENT-HANDOVER.md`	Signed Lahore launch checklist
`SOFTWARE-GUIDE.html`	Printable full guide (open in browser → Print → PDF)
`AUTHORIZATION.md`	Role permissions (admin)
`BACKUP-RECOVERY.md`	Disaster recovery (admin)
`document-numbering.md`	Invoice/PO number sequences

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